Sandy Toes, Salty Kisses

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/90000226.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Day At The Beach, Fluff, Romantic Fluff, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Soft Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Post-Canon, One Shot, Short & Sweet

Language:
English

Series:
Part 4 of In Every Season

Stats:
Published: 2026-08-06 Words: 1,540 Chapters: 1/1

Sandy Toes, Salty Kisses

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/90000226.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Day At The Beach, Fluff, Romantic Fluff, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Soft Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Post-Canon, One Shot, Short & Sweet

Language:
English

Series:
Part 4 of In Every Season

Stats:
Published: 2026-08-06 Words: 1,540 Chapters: 1/1

Sandy Toes, Salty Kisses

by NotMyDestiny

Summary

Adora and Catra get the beach day they deserve.

The beach lay awash in a dreamy brightness. Multiple daymoons hung big in the sky, their light reflecting off the sea in a thousand shifting, shimmering bits. The coastline was alive with sound. The steady roll of the tide was a rhythmic push and pull punctuated by the soft, trilling calls of seabirds. A hint of salt carried on the warm breeze and bright shells were half-buried in the pale sand where the tide had recently receded.

The path had opened all at once onto the shoreline. Soft, shifting sand gave way beneath their feet, warming the soles with the heat of the day. The Seaworthy beach was small and secluded. Adora grabbed Catra's hand and pulled her forward.

"Adora," Catra complained, but there was no weight in it, just the familiar light tease as she let herself be tugged along.

The sand clung briefly to Adora's toes before she shook it loose. The breeze was light in her hair as she darted forward. She reached the edge of the water and stopped just long enough to take it in, shoulders lifting with a breath that looked like it filled her all the way through.

Catra settled on the beach, sprawling out across the sand languidly and feeling the kind of warmth that sank in slowly then stayed. She lay with her arms folded behind her head and watched Adora moving through the water, unbothered by the push of the tide. She couldn't help but notice the way Adora tipped her head back when a wave hit higher than she expected, laughing like it surprised her every time. The light caught in her golden hair, in the spray, in the restless surface of the sea.

Catra's chest tightened, but not in the old way. Growing up in the Horde, Adora had never had this. There had been no beach outings, no salt spray, no unguarded joy. There had been only training simulations and sickly green lights reflecting off metal walls that closed in. Adora had been bright even there, but not like this.

Adora emerged from a wave dripping and laughing, utterly alive. She dropped down beside Catra without a word, cool skin next to warm and damp beside dry. Catra made a quiet, annoyed sound, but she didn't move away. She shifted just enough to make space, one arm sliding automatically around Adora's waist as she settled in. Catra didn't look when she reached for her. She didn't need to.

Adora felt Catra's arm around her waist, the warm body against her wet skin, the tail curling loosely around her ankle, none of it asked anything of her. It simply assumed she belonged there. Catra's thumb brushed sand from her side with an unhurried touch, and Adora's breath slowed to match the rhythm of it.

"You got me wet," Catra grumbled playfully.

"You survived," Adora teased back.

"Barely." Catra flicked a handful of sand at Adora's shoulder, just enough to scatter.

Adora could feel the steady beat of Catra's heart, the warmth of her palm resting against her hip. Above them, the moons drifted, light shifting across their faces in slow, kaleidoscopic patterns. The sea kept its rhythm, ancient and unconcerned.

With one finger, she traced something absentmindedly into the sand. Ease settled through Adora in a way that used to be rare and now wasn't. There had been years when an afternoon like this would have seemed impossible, when stillness was needed for preparation, rather than a place to rest. Back then every beautiful place had also been a battlefield, every journey another mission, every quiet moment only borrowed before someone needed She-Ra again.

"Your hair's a disaster," Catra said, but her fingers were already sliding through the damp strands, separating them with a gentleness that contradicted her words.

"Is that a complaint?"

“Just stating a fact.” Catra gathered a section near Adora’s temple, her claws carefully sheathed, and began to braid it idly. She kept it loose. Adora went still under the touch, her shoulders dropping as Catra worked. When she finished, she tucked it behind Adora’s ear and let her hand linger there, thumb tracing its curve.

Adora made a small, contented noise and shifted, turning onto her back and settling her head into Catra’s lap. The position left her looking up at the sky, at Catra’s face silhouetted against the daymoons. Catra’s hand found its way to the space behind Adora’s ear, claws scratching lightly, and Adora’s eyes fluttered shut.

“You’re gonna fall asleep,” Catra purred.

“Not possible,” Adora murmured, though her voice was already drifting. “Too much to look at.”

“Like what?”

“Like you.”

Catra’s ears flattened slightly, but her fingers didn’t stop moving. Her thumb lingered for a heartbeat longer.

The tide had pulled back a little farther, leaving a fresh stretch of wet sand glittering with shells and polished stones. Adora's eyes caught on one glinting near the surf.

Catra recognized the look before Adora even scrambled upright. “Adora…” Catra started, but Adora was already on her feet, rushing toward the waterline.

Adora crouched, picking up something small and spiral-shaped, turning it in her fingers so it caught the light. Then she was moving again, collecting, gathering. She picked up a fan-shaped shell in pale pink, then a stone worn smooth and vaguely heart-shaped. She held each one up like a treasure, calling back to Catra with every discovery.

“Catra, look at this one! It’s got stripes!”

“Catra, Catra… this one matches your eyes!”

Catra propped herself up on her elbows, watching Adora hop from one discovery to the next, her bare feet leaving prints that the tide began immediately to erase. She made a show of sighing, of looking unimpressed, but she catalogued each shell. Catra noticed the enthusiasm in Adora’s voice, the way she shook water from her fingers before handling something delicate, the absolute sincerity with which she presented each find as if it were the most important thing in the world.

Adora came back with her hands full, dropping down cross-legged in the sand and spreading her collection between them. She picked up an oblong shell, the outside a weathered teal, its inner curve lined with pearlescent gold.

“This one,” she said, holding it out. “This is the one. Your eyes.”

Catra took it, turning it over once. It was pretty, she supposed. Not that she cared about shells. She made a noncommittal sound and set it down with the others, then stretched back out on the sand, closing her eyes against the brightness.

When Adora darted up to chase a seabird’s shadow down the beach, Catra’s hand drifted to the pile of shells. She palmed the dual-colored one and slipped it into her shorts pocket, quick and furtive, her tail twitching once before going still.

They ate lunch as the largest daymoon climbed toward its peak. Adora unpacked the small bundle she had insisted on bringing. It held sweet, sticky fruit sliced into wedges, flatbread still warm from the oven, and a soft cheese that tasted of herbs neither of them could name. Adora fed Catra a piece of fruit with her fingers, juice dripping down her wrist, and Catra caught it with her tongue before it could fall, her eyes never leaving Adora’s face.

“You’re messy,” Catra said.

“You’re not complaining.”

“I’m stating a fact.” Catra smiled despite herself.

Adora laughed, bright and easy, and took a bite of flatbread. They passed the waterskin between them. The conversation moved in lazy circles as they chatted about whether the tide was coming in or going out, whether the birds overhead were the same kind that nested near Bright Moon, whether Adora would tell Bow about all her shell discoveries. Nothing important, just voices, comfortable and unhurried.

Afterward, they wandered down to the tide-line, staying where the sand felt damp but not too wet beneath their feet. They walked close enough that their shoulders kept brushing. Then they sat together, knees drawn up and toes buried in the cool, wet sand. Adora leaned against Catra’s side, and Catra hooked her tail loosely around Adora’s waist. Their hands rested together between them, fingers fitting without thought.

Out over the water, seabirds wheeled and dove, dropping in sharp, sudden plunges before emerging with silver flashes in their beaks.

“Do you think they ever miss?” Adora asked.

“What?”

“The birds. When they dive. Do you think they ever come up empty?”

Catra watched one drop like a stone, vanish beneath the surface for three long seconds, then rise with something wriggling in its beak. “Probably.”

“But they keep diving.”

“Yeah.” Catra’s thumb moved slowly over Adora’s knuckles. “They keep diving.”

Adora was quiet for a moment. “I like that.”

Catra glanced at her. Adora’s face was turned toward the sea, her expression thoughtful but still easy, no tension gathering beneath it. She rested her cheek against Catra’s shoulder.

The shell pressed against Catra’s thigh when she shifted. Sea spray misted their faces softly. When Catra turned her head, Adora was already looking at her and the kiss tasted of salt and ease.

They stayed like that, the warmth of the sand beneath them and the steady sound of the sea in front of them, nothing held too tight, nothing slipping away.



Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!